

documents formatted and printed. You could even make simple presentations in PowerPoint.

Further, you can do this on a regular basis for small companies which don't have computers and need to outsource their word processing requirements. You'll need a word processor, a spreadsheet and presentation software and some hard disk space to store documents and templates. You will also need a printer.

The skillsets you need are: an ability to format documents and slides, a good typing speed, and a fair amount of proficiency in the language you're supposed to work in.

You can also layout and format brochures, posters, business cards and magazines. However, you'll need to know desktop processing (DTP) software such as Adobe Pagemaker or QuarkXPress. Simple posters or layouts can be laid out in Microsoft Word.

How much can you earn?

Typing and formatting a single page of a document in say Word can get you about Rs 25 to 30. DTP with software like Quark or Pagemaker can get you a marginally higher amount.

4 Affiliate marketing

'Get a FREE Radio and the Shopper's Edge!' How many times have you received a message like this in your inbox? If you happen to be among those whose inbox gets flooded, you'll know exactly what we mean. However, all of this is not spam—some marketing is pretty targeted actually and there are many new Web sites and products coming up, all of them wanting to target more and more customers. This is accomplished through a network of people online. These people make money by promoting other Web sites and products (known as affiliate marketing) through different ways.

You can do this from your home with a PC and an Internet connection. There are different types of programs that you can join. If you have a Web site, you can host banners on your site and direct traffic to a site via clicks on the banner; alternatively, you can send out e-mail containing links to people whose e-mail addresses you know, or obtain databases of e-mail addresses to send mail to.

Affiliate tracking software keeps a tab on how many people have visited a Web site through you, and you get paid

accordingly. There are several programmes that you can join. The trick is to wisely choose the right combination of programs. It's all about time in the end.

How much can you earn?

In the best situation you could make Rs 5000 per month.

5 Web designing

With more individuals and organisations wanting an online presence, the demand for good designers who can create and design Web sites, whether



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“Web design is not just about laying out text and images. It's also about finding a balance between utility and aesthetics, creativity and structure”

huge sites with complex navigation or simple Web pages, is increasing.

You don't need to be an artist or have any formal qualifications in art to be a Web designer. What you need is a good design sense, an understanding of the visual element, and creativity.

You'll need software such as Photoshop or Paintshop Pro for image editing, Dreamweaver for page creation and other software such as 3D Studio MAX, Corel Draw, Flash and CuteFTP in your toolkit. You should have a databank of images, possess a working knowledge of HTML and FTP, and be adept at increasing the

scope of your visual imagination.

How much can you earn?

This varies according to skill, the size of the Web site to be developed and technologies used, for example Flash, PHP, etc. A few Web pages could bring in Rs 5,000 to 6,000 while a fairly large Web site could earn you upward of Rs 15,000.

6 Writing

Though writing or the ability to write doesn't have anything to do with owning a PC, it's pretty much crucial that every writer has a PC. For starters, word

processors such as Word or Star Writer make editing text easier. Then you need to have a 'soft copy' of the data as the layout of text for either printing or Web publishing is done on a computer.

Magazines, newspapers, journals, Web sites, advertising agencies, software companies—they all need people to write articles, manuals, brochures, etc on topics as diverse as gardening and greenhouse warming. Of course, the style of writing and the flair will vary, depending more on who you are writing for. Use the power that you have with the Web, get in touch with people who can help and guide you and get you in touch with publications worldwide. In other words, use your PC as a tool to write your way to success.

How much can you earn?

This varies according to experience. It starts from Re 1 per word to about Rs 3 a word if you're really good.

7 Computer training

If you are a techie, or happen to know enough about technology to teach others, try opening a small training institute of your own. If you have attributes such as patience, tolerance and the desire to teach, you will discover that teaching and training is a very rewarding way of making money.

That's not all...

Some more ways to get rich!

There are several schemes online that can make you some money. Though the halcyon dotcom days when you could make money off virtually anything have come to an end, sites still exist which offer you points or credits that can be redeemed for money. For example, filling out online surveys, contests, registering for a service, and so on. However, you can't make much money out of this since most of these programmes are located overseas and redeeming points for cash is a major problem.